



Life zones

LIFE ON EARTH can be organized into a number of *large ecosystems*, or biomes. **Biomes** are based on geographic regions that have similar climates (how hot or cold, windy or rainy a place is). You can find the same type of biome on different continents and in different hemispheres but the *animal and plant species* in each one varies widely.

TEMPERATE FOREST

Trees in this biome are broad-leaved varieties that drop their leaves in winter. There are distinct seasons and regular rainfall throughout the year. Animals that live in these areas feed mainly on seeds, nuts, leaves, and berries or are omnivores (they eat meat and plants).



TROPICAL FORESTS

The hot, wet, and sunny climate of tropical forests is ideal for tree growth. Most of the animals live in trees and there is always something in flower or fruit for them to eat throughout the year. This biome contains more species of plants, animals, and fungi than any other.



MOUNTAINS

Mountains are a mixture of habitats: their peaks can be cold, windy, and rocky with little plant life, but as you come down the slopes the landscape changes to bushes or conifers, then broadleaf trees. Valleys at the bottom are often very fertile and covered with meadows and forests.

